conflicting interests, differences in information sets, and legitimate differences in how information is analysed.

The protagonists of a conflict criticize each other. The media creates rancour by playing up conflict. We should disagree in polite language, maintain good personal relationships, and work through formal procedures for resolving conflicts. But we should be comfortable with conflict as the normal state. In fact, it is only in an authoritarian regime that conflict is squelched, as persons are too fearful to speak up. *If two people agree on everything, only one is doing the thinking.*

The under-supply of criticism

We must recognize that in every society, there is a market failure in the form of an under-supply of criticism. Criticizing the government imposes costs upon the critic.

The gains from criticism are diffused; the entire society benefits from the criticism. The self-interest of the critic leads her to ignore the gains for society at large, and thus to under-supply criticism. [3]

In July 2018, Xu Zhangrun, a law professor at Tsinghua University in Beijing wrote a tough review of the hard-line policies of Xi Jinping, the revival of communist orthodoxy and the adulatory propaganda surrounding Xi Jinping and the regime. Prof. Xu Zhangrun's essay has text such as: 'People nationwide, including the entire bureaucratic elite, feel once more lost in uncertainty about the direction of the country and about their own personal security, and the rising anxiety has spread into a degree of panic throughout society.' Such writing by intellectuals is the essence of building a civilized society, and imposes positive externalities upon the Chinese populace.

However, Prof. Xu Zhangrun is alone in facing the attacks from the regime. He has been suspended, barred from teaching, investigated and barred from leaving the country. [4] The externalities do not accrue to Xu